

Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA)

What this tool produces · *A formal environmental report detailing the project's likely significant effects on biodiversity, soil, water, air, and health, along with mandatory mitigation measures.*

G2 · Proof of Fit

G4 · Proof of Sustainability

Dimensions

Environmental

Regulation

Preparing the workshop · *Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA)*

G2 · Proof of Fit

Why this tool matters

Establishing a legal shield for the natural world, forcing the machinery of urban construction to pause, reflect, and justify its impact on the silent stakeholders: the soil, the water, and the air.

Evidence we produce

A formal environmental report detailing the project's likely significant effects on biodiversity, soil, water, air, and health, along with mandatory mitigation measures.

Duration & Material

Duration · 6 to 18 months depending on legal complexity

Material · Environmental baseline data, European Directive compliance checklists, public consultation platforms

Reference case

Under the EU EIA Directive, major infrastructure works must be rigorously assessed. For example, in Ireland, the failure to conduct a proper EIA for a large terrestrial wind-farm led to a catastrophic landslide during construction, polluting a river and killing 50,000 fish. This highlighted that assessing soil stability and disaster risk through a formal EIA is absolutely crucial before any earth is moved.

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

EIA matrix · components × phases × significance

Duration
6 to 18 months depending on legal complexity

Component	Construction	Operation	Decommissioning
Air			
Water			
Soil			
Biodiversity			
Noise			
Landscape			
Heritage			
Population			

Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.